

T U E S D A Y

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT (PPE)

Gloves

SCRIPTURE TEXT:

**“You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart,
with all your soul, and with all your strength.”**

Deuteronomy 6: 5 (NKJV)



LESSON OBJECTIVE

Prior to the pandemic that started in 2020, few people outside the health care community knew anything about personal protective equipment (PPE). That changed very fast. Most medical professionals think of PPE in terms of the five areas most vulnerable to health enemies or threats: eyes and face, hands, body, respiratory system, and ears or hearing. These areas are points of entry for any wicked virus like COVID-19. Each category has specific safety equipment, and there's a right way and a wrong way to put on the PPE. For example, when putting on a face mask, the nose and mouth must be covered, not just the mouth. And it should fit snugly. There's a proper way to wash one's hands as well, like singing happy birthday. You get the idea.

To protect ourselves from our spiritual “enemies,” we also need to put on the proper protective gear. The apostle Paul uses military metaphors; speaking of helmets, swords, breastplates, etc., to protect us from Satan's evil helpers that threaten to attack our homes and families. Pray today for God's protective covering on every family member and to also protect our eyes, ears, and mouth from harmful influences. Choose good over evil. **“Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the schemes of the devil. For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against rulers, against authorities, against cosmic powers...”**
Ephesians 6:11,12



The battle between good and evil is playing out in our homes.

Read 1 Kings 18:20-40,
Ephesians 6:10-17

The contest was a relatively simple one. The prophets of Baal would build an altar for their god, and Elijah would make one for his. It would be a battle of the gods. Elijah -- Yahweh's prophet -- and the priests of Baal would cut up a bull for sacrifice on each altar but not put fire on it. They would rely on their deity to do that. The altar that got fired up first would be the winner, and that god would be the god of the people. After six hours of crying and pleading to Baal by the prophets of Baal, there was no fire. Despite all the uproar, the writer of 1 Kings tells us: "There was no voice, no answer, and no response" (v. 29).

Now it was Elijah's turn. He rebuilt the altar of the Lord that had been torn down for some time, taking 12 stones as a symbol for the 12 tribes of Israel. Then he dug a trench around it. After arranging the wood and the pieces of the bull, he had four jars of water poured over the altar three times, soaking everything thoroughly and even filling up the trench around the altar. Then Elijah prays: "O Lord, God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, let it be known this day that you are God in Israel, that I am your servant, and that I have done all these things at your bidding. Answer me, Lord, answer me, so that this people may know that you, O Lord, are God, and that you have turned their hearts back" (v. 36-37).

A cosmic drama, what is called the great controversy, is being played out in our families today and evil minions are doing their best to crowd out God in our homes. Television, social media, smartphones, and other devices have consumed much of our families' time, attention, and maybe even affection. While the impact may have damaging effects on mental health, social skills, memory, and self-image, a more immediate and powerful influence is experienced daily in our homes. A lack of interaction is causing a significant disconnect between husband and wife, parent, and child, leading to silly arguments

and senseless hurts. These seemingly little hurts lead to larger destruction of our homes.

The truth is that if we spend more time with 'false gods,' it will be harder for us to really know the voice of the one true God and even more difficult to worship Him. Remember the old sayings, "we are what we eat?" or "GIGO—garbage in, garbage out?" Well, the same is true for our minds. Our minds are deeply influenced by what we see and hear, affecting what we think and do. As such, we must arm our families against the enemy's wiles. **"Therefore, take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand."** Ephesians 6:13.

When we study God's word daily and pray for his protection over our family, claiming Jesus' victory over Satan, we choose good over evil. Our minds will be transformed and ready to hear God's voice. We become more aware of the enemy's strategies and are better prepared for the attacks against our families. We become more courageous and consciously choose to reject the values and beliefs that do not align with our family mission statement. When we pray for a hedge of protection around our family, angels that excel in strength are commissioned, and the evil forces retreat from the battle. Will you choose today to be on the side of Christ? Jesus Wins!

PRAYER

Dear God, thank You for Jesus, the Great Protector. Thank You for the opportunity to come boldly before Your throne of mercy to call on You, like Elijah, to perform miracles in our families. Please put a hedge of protection around our family (name everyone in your home) and those who have wandered away from You. We want to be on Your side until You return to take us home with You. In Jesus' name, amen.



APPLY IT & LIVE IT

BIBLE CHALLENGE

Practice the memory verse together as a family. See who is ready to say it from memory. If everyone already has it memorized, consider memorizing the entire **Shema** (Deuteronomy 6:4-9).



REBUILDING THE FAMILY ALTAR

Make a phone/device basket and have everyone (including adults) put their devices in the basket during dinner and worship time. Discuss this new family rule during a family meeting or put on your family mission statement that dinner time and worship time will be a phone-free zone.

Choose a special place in your home where you can pray together first thing in the morning. Kneel facing each other, making a family altar. You can also remain standing and hold hands. Have each person say a short prayer. Close with a bible text such as Psalm 19:14, **“Let the words of my mouth and the meditation of my heart, be acceptable in your sight, O Lord, my strength and my Redeemer.”** End with a family group hug.

Evening worship time is a great time for relationship building. Start your evening worship by asking each person any of the following questions (including parents): What were your miracles today? What were your challenges? What was the nicest thing that someone did for you today? What was the nicest thing you did for someone today? What are you most grateful for today? Sing your worship song, read a text, and pray. End with a family group hug.



FAMILY TALK

Answer individually and as a family:

- What is the great controversy?
- How does this affect our family?
- What must we do to put a hedge of protection around our family members?
- How can I choose good over evil every day? (eg. use kind words, be honest, show respect, be grateful, spend less time on phone and more time with the family, etc.)

ILLUSTRATION FOR CHILDREN

Hold up a construction helmet, then ask: Is this the only piece of equipment needed to protect a construction worker? While the helmet is very important so are the shirt, pants, and especially boots and gloves! Construction workers wear special protective gloves and boots. In the same way, we need special equipment to be good Christians. The apostle Paul says we need “the helmet of salvation” (Ephesians 6:17), which protects us from losing God’s gift of everlasting life. Ask the children if there is anything else we need. Note that Paul recommends “the belt of truth” (v. 14), which wraps God’s truth around us ... special shoes to help us go and “proclaim the gospel of peace” (v. 15) ... and “the shield of faith” (v. 16), which protects us from evil. Ask the children if they can buy this special equipment in a store. No! Tell them that the best place to get these items is in church, where they can learn all about salvation, truth, peace, and faith. Remind the children that they need all these things, and that one piece of equipment isn’t enough. Encourage them to keep coming to family worship and church and church school, until their Christian uniform is complete.

